TASK SIX

Greenbone Vulnerability Assessment Report

Workflow documentation — lab setup through scan preparation and the confirmed stopping point

Scanning machine	Kali Linux
Target machine	Metasploitable 2
Target IP	10.0.2.3
Greenbone interface	https://127.0.0.1:9392
Scan task	Metasploitable Vulnerability Scan

This report records the preparation of a Greenbone vulnerability assessment. The actual scan was not launched; no vulnerability findings or scan results are claimed.

1. Introduction and Lab Setup

The objective is to prepare a vulnerability assessment of a deliberately vulnerable Linux system using Greenbone Vulnerability Management (GVM) and its OpenVAS scanner.

Lab environment
• Kali Linux — scanning machine running Greenbone.
• Metasploitable 2 — intentionally vulnerable target.
• Target IP — **10.0.2.3**.
• Greenbone interface — **https://127.0.0.1:9392**.

How we obtained the target IP: Metasploitable 2 was started in the lab and its network address was identified as **10.0.2.3**. Connectivity to that address was checked before it was entered into Greenbone. The retained notes confirm the address and successful connectivity check, but do not preserve the exact original IP-discovery command. No command has therefore been guessed or presented as one we executed.

2. Starting the Virtual Machines and Greenbone

Both virtual machines must be powered on in VirtualBox before the assessment: Kali Linux operates Greenbone, and Metasploitable 2 is the target. The VM startup method is described without claiming an unconfirmed VirtualBox terminal command.

Command used in the lab

```
sudo gvm-start
```

What it does: Starts the Greenbone services used by the manager, scanner and web interface. This is the startup command confirmed in the task history.

Additional reference command

```
sudo systemctl start gvmd ospd-openvas gsad
```

What it does: Starts the three named Greenbone services through systemd: gvmd (manager), ospd-openvas (scanner service) and gsad (web interface). This is an additional reference/alternative command, not one confirmed as executed during this task.

These are three services running within Kali Linux, not three separate virtual machines.

3. Accessing Greenbone

After starting Greenbone, open a browser and visit **https://127.0.0.1:9392**. Sign in using the administrator account. Passwords and other credentials are intentionally omitted.

4. Identifying and Creating the Target

Metasploitable 2 was identified as the target. Its address, **10.0.2.3**, was used in Greenbone. Navigate to **Configuration** → **Targets** → **New Target** and configure:

Field	Value
Name	Metasploitable
Hosts	10.0.2.3

Save the target so it can be selected when creating the scan task.

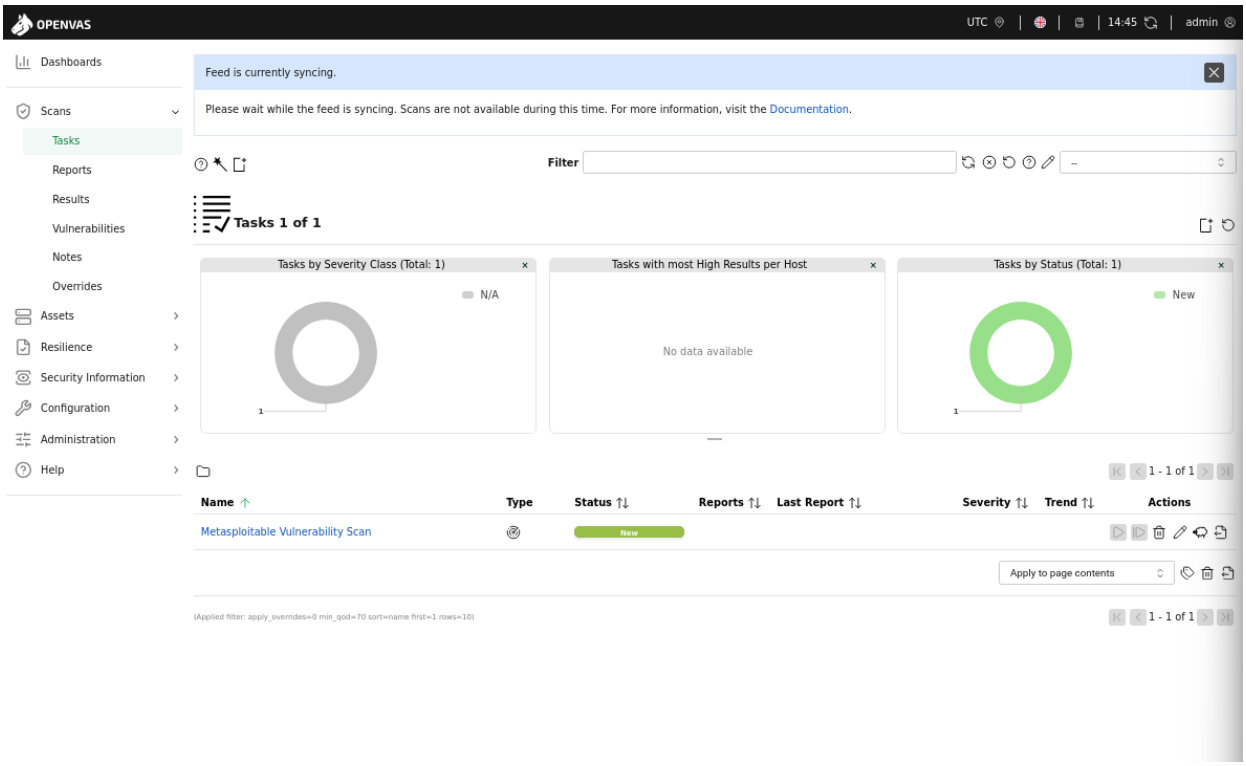


Figure 1. Captured Greenbone view from target/task setup.

5. Creating the Vulnerability Scan Task

Navigate to **Scans** → **Tasks** → **New Task**. The task was configured as follows:

Field	Selected value
Task name	Metasploitable Vulnerability Scan
Target	Metasploitable
Scan configuration	Full and fast
Scanner	OpenVAS Default

Full and fast is the selected scan configuration. **OpenVAS Default** is the selected scanner. Saving this task prepares the scan; it does not mean that a scan has run.

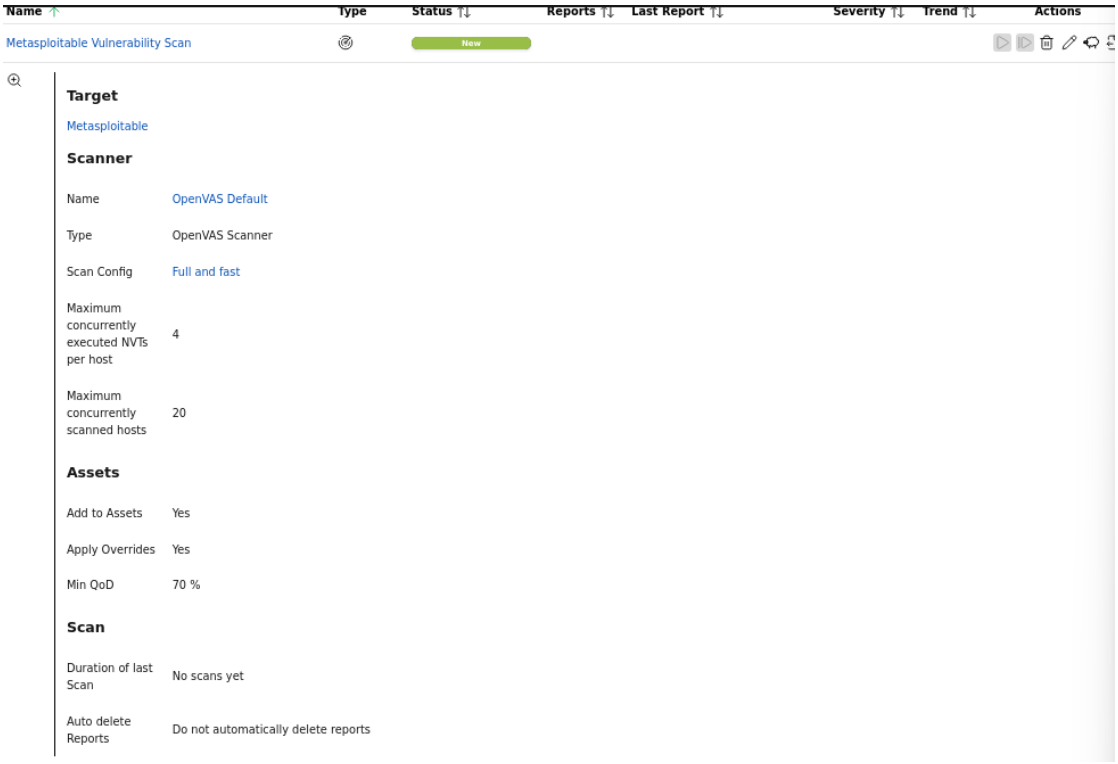


Figure 2. Task details showing target, scanner and scan configuration.

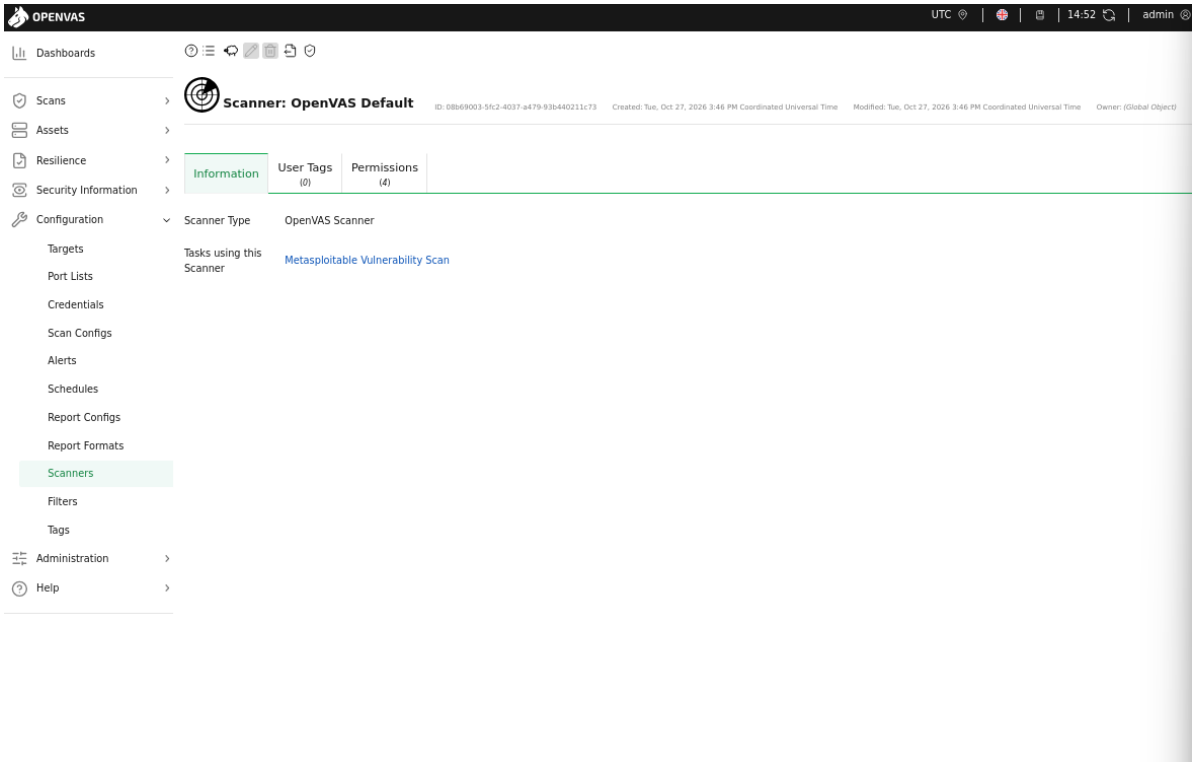


Figure 3. OpenVAS Default scanner details and task assignment.

6. Scanner Verification

The OpenVAS Default scanner was checked in the Greenbone interface. Scanner verification succeeded. This confirms that the scanner entry was verified; it does not mean the vulnerability scan itself was executed.

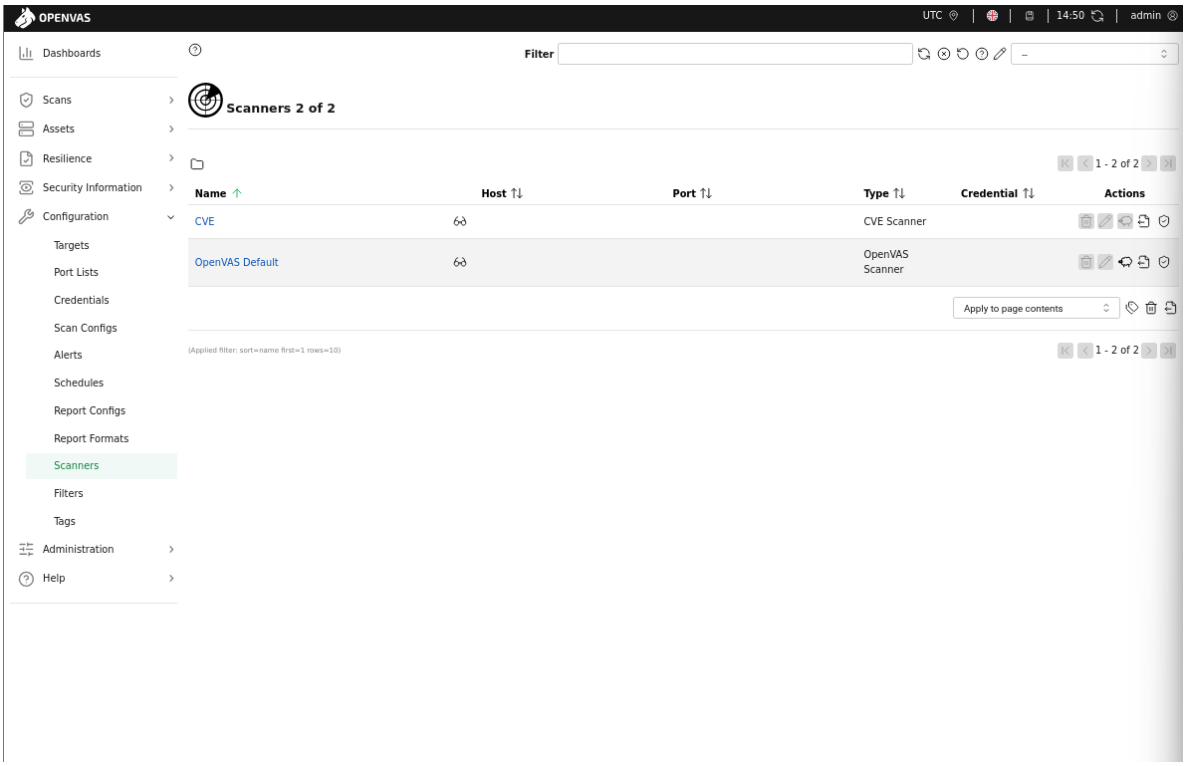


Figure 4. Scanner list showing OpenVAS Default and its verification.

7. Feed Synchronisation Status

Greenbone uses feed data to provide vulnerability tests and supporting security information. The captured Feed Status page showed:

Feed	Observed status
NVT	Scanner is still starting
SCAP	Update in progress
GVMD_DATA	Update in progress

These statuses show that feed preparation had not reached a completed state in the captured session. This was part of the condition encountered while trying to start the scan.

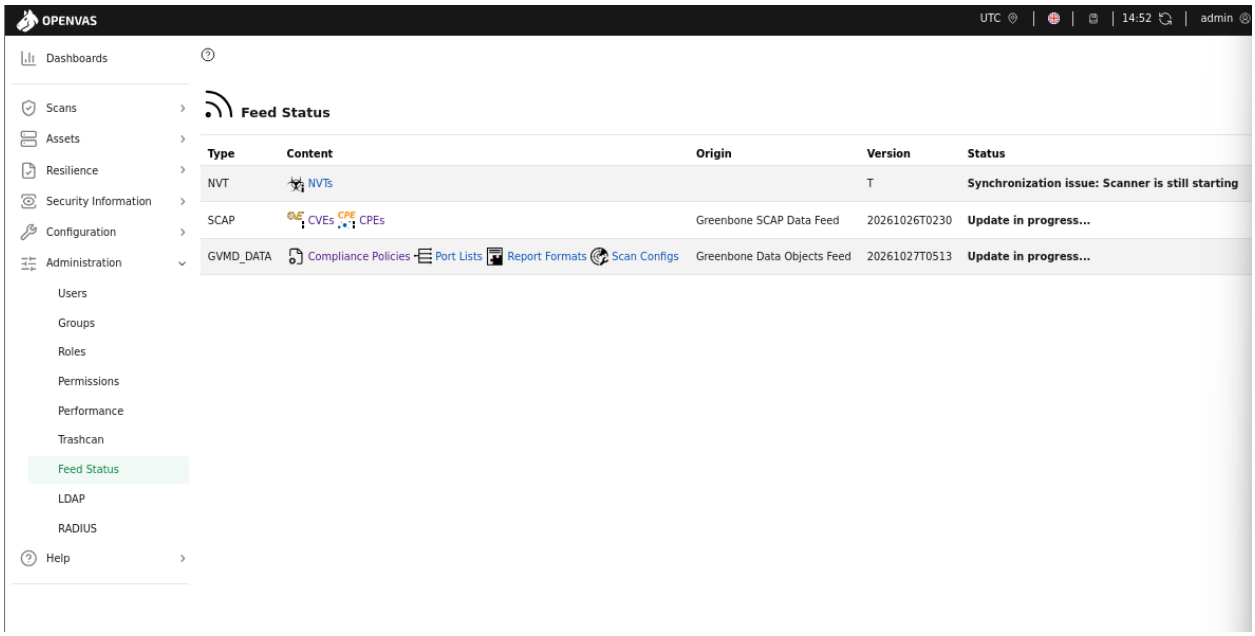
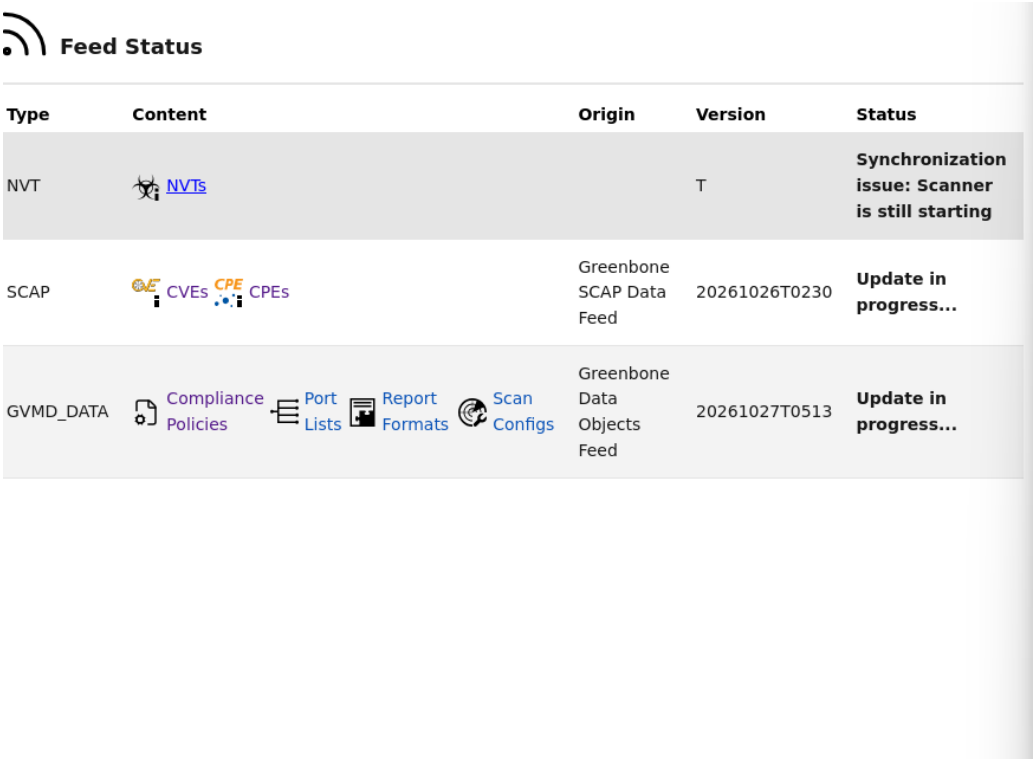


Figure 5. Feed Status showing NVT startup and SCAP/GVMD_DATA updates in progress.



Feed Status

Type	Content	Origin	Version	Status
NVT	NVTs		T	**Synchronization issue: Scanner is still starting**
SCAP	CVEs CPEs	Greenbone SCAP Data Feed	20261026T0230	**Update in progress...**
GVMD_DATA	Compliance Policies, Port Lists, Report Formats, Scan Configs	Greenbone Data Objects Feed	20261027T0513	**Update in progress...**

Figure 6. Earlier Feed Status screenshot supplied during the task.

8. Terminal Checks and Service Restart

The following commands were confirmed in the troubleshooting history. The process IDs below refer to the specific synchronisation processes observed at that time.

```
sudo fuser -v /var/lib/gvm/feed-update.lock
```

What it does: Displays processes currently using the Greenbone feed-update lock file. During one check, processes belonging to the _gvm account were listed.

```
ps -p 199106,199115 -o pid,etime,%cpu,stat,cmd
```

What it does: Displays the selected process IDs, elapsed time, CPU usage, process state and command. The output showed Greenbone synchronisation processes.

```
sudo gvm-stop
```

What it does: Stops the Greenbone services. This command was used during troubleshooting.

```
sudo gvm-start
```

What it does: Starts Greenbone services again after they were stopped.

After the restart, the feed lock was checked again. The user reported that the command returned no output, meaning no process was listed as holding the lock at that moment. The disabled Start control nevertheless remained unresolved.

9. Final Status — Exact Stopping Point

At the final check, **Metasploitable Vulnerability Scan** remained in **New** status. The Start/play control was greyed out and disabled. Therefore, the actual vulnerability scan could not be launched.

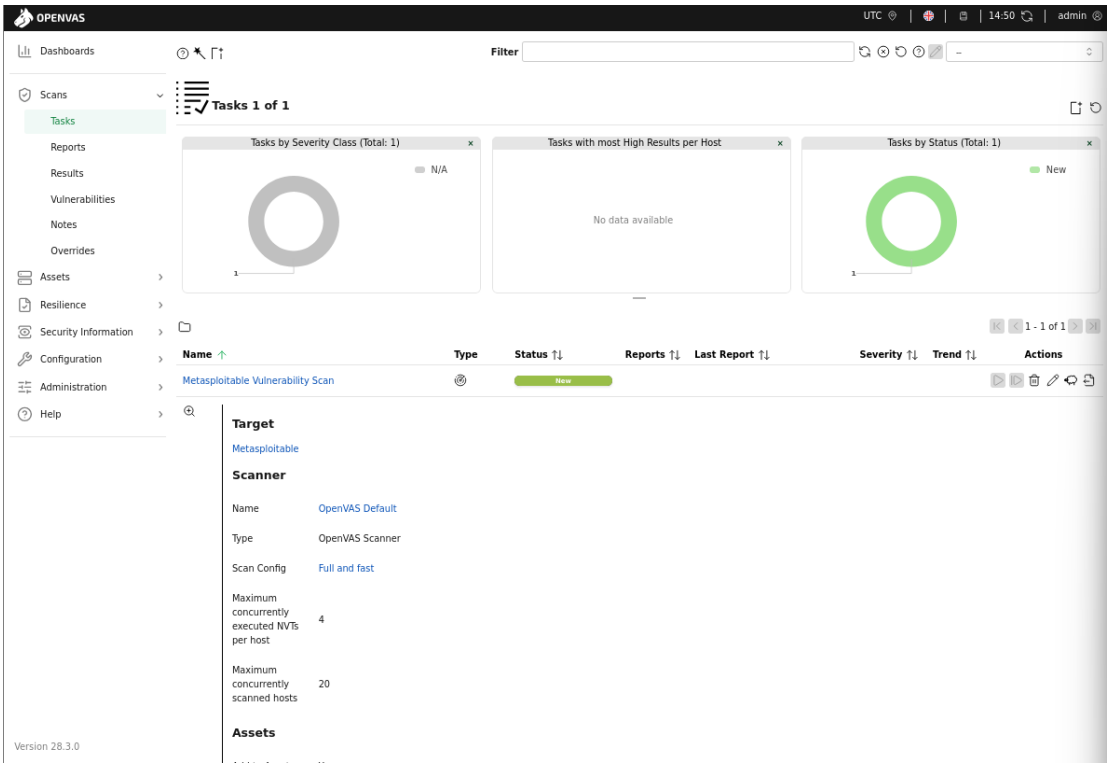


Figure 7. Tasks page showing New status and unavailable Start control.

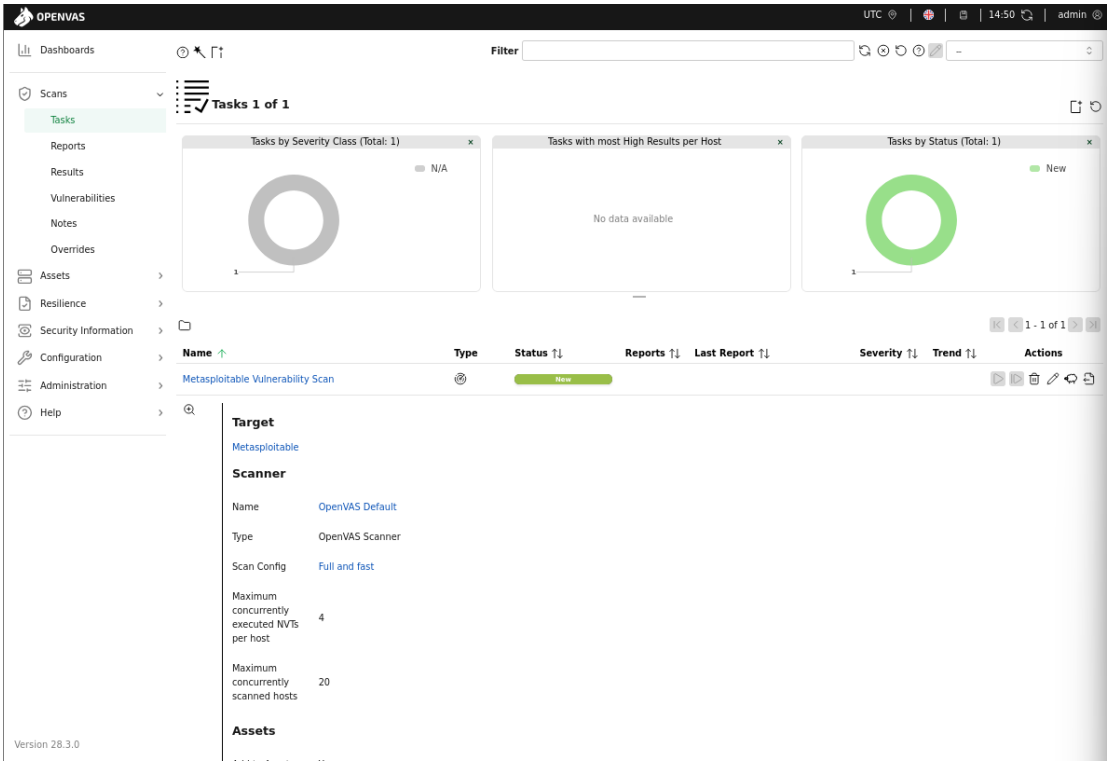


Figure 8. Final task view showing Metasploitable, OpenVAS Default and Full and fast.

Stopping point: The target and scan task were configured, and scanner verification succeeded. Feed synchronisation was still incomplete in the captured status, and the Start control remained disabled. No scan execution, vulnerability findings, severity ratings or completed scan report are claimed.

10. Conclusion

The Greenbone assessment was prepared through lab setup, target identification, target creation, task creation and scanner verification. Work stopped before scan execution because the task remained in New status with the Start control disabled. This report records the completed preparation and observed stopping point without presenting unperformed work as completed.

Accuracy note: Commands confirmed in the task history are presented as executed commands. The systemctl startup command is labelled as an additional reference. The exact original IP-discovery command was not preserved and has not been reconstructed.